Qp Code: 25900026

MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-BBA (HONOURS) REGULAR EXAMINATION, MARCH 2025

SECOND SEMESTER

Core Course (CC)-MG2CCRBBA100-ORGANISATIONAL BEHAVIOUR

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

DURATION: 2 Hours **Maximum Marks: 70**

PART –A (5x3=15)

If at least two points in answer, or answer with relevant explanation should be given maximum marks.

1.a)Apply sociological concept to suggest solutions to organisational behaviour

Here are some sociological concepts applied to organizational behaviour:

1**. Social Learning Theory**: Use role models and mentoring to promote positive behaviours.

2. Symbolic Interactionism: Improve communication by being aware of nonverbal cues and language.

3. Social Exchange Theory: Offer fair compensation and recognition to promote employee engagement.

These concepts can help organisations address issues like employee motivation, communication, and teamwork.

(Mark can be awarded for any other related point/concept)

1.b)List and explain any three objectives of organisational behaviour with illustration.

(Give full marks even if no illustration is written), (Mark can be awarded for any objectives)

Here are three objectives of Organisational Behaviour:

1. Understanding Employee Behaviour: To comprehend why employees behave in certain ways.
- Illustration: A manager understands an employee's tardiness is due to transportation issues.

2. Predicting Employee Behaviour: To forecast how employees will react in different situations.
- Illustration: A leader anticipates team resistance to changes and prepares a clear explanation.

3. Controlling and Managing Employee Behaviour: To influence employee behaviour to achieve organizational goals.
- Illustration: A company sets clear expectations and provides training to improve customer service skills.

2.a)Compare internal and external factors of perception with example .

(Give full marks even if there is no explanation)

Here's a comparison of internal and external factors of perception

1. Attitudes: Preconceived notions or biases

Example: A manager with a positive attitude towards teamwork is more likely to perceive a collaborative effort as successful.

2. Expectations: Prior experiences or expectations influence perception

Example: An employee expecting a promotion may perceive a meeting with the boss as an opportunity for discussion.

3. Motivation: Personal goals or needs influence perception

Example: A hungry employee may perceive the break room as an opportunity for food.

External Factors:

1. Environment: Physical surroundings influence perception

Example: A noisy office may lead to distractions and affect perception of work quality.

2. Social Influence: Others' opinions or behaviours influence perception

Example: Colleagues' positive feedback may influence an employee's perception of their work.

3. Cultural Background: Cultural norms and values shape perception

Example: A gesture considered polite in one culture may be perceived as rude in another.

2.b)Explain how neuroticism impacts an individual.

Neuroticism can lead to increased anxiety, stress, and emotional instability, affecting an individual's well-being, relationships, and overall quality of life. It may also impact their ability to cope with challenges and make decisions.

(Mark can be awarded for any other related point/concept)

3. a)Examine how the effective component of attitude affects the decision making behaviour of the superior?

The effective component of a superior's attitude, encompassing their feelings and emotions, significantly influences their decision-making behaviour. A positive, emotionally stable attitude can lead to more rational, data-driven decisions, while negative emotions like anger, fear, or stress can result in impulsive, biased, and potentially detrimental choices.

(Mark can be awarded for any other related point/concept)

3. b)Interpret how individual reassess goals during middle adulthood and why it matters.

During middle adulthood, individuals reassess goals due to:

1. Changing priorities (e.g., family, health)

2. Reflecting on accomplishments and regrets

3. Considering mortality and legacy

This reassessment matters because it can lead to:

1. Greater self-awareness

2. Refocused priorities

3. Increased life satisfaction

By re-evaluating goals, individuals can make meaningful changes and align their actions with their values, leading to a more fulfilling life.

(Mark can be awarded for any other related point/concept)

4. a)Discuss cognition and describe its role in individual behaviour.

(Give full marks even if only definition/role written, Mark can be awarded for any other related point/concept)

Cognition refers to mental processes like perception, attention, memory, and problem-solving. Its role in individual behaviour includes:

1. Interpreting information

2. Making decisions

3. Solving problems

4. Learning and adapting

Cognition influences how individuals process information, perceive reality, and respond to situations, shaping their behaviour and interactions.

4. b)According to self-determination theory formulate the three innate psychological needs that are essential for human motivation and wellbeing?

According to Self-Determination Theory, the three innate psychological needs are:

1. Autonomy (control over one's life)
2. Competence (feeling effective and capable)
3. Relatedness (connecting with others)
These needs are essential for human motivation, well-being, and psychological growth
5. a)Illustrate the two factors that influence motivation, according to Herzberg's theory?
Factors Influencing Motivation:
1. Hygiene Factors: Basic needs (salary, job security, work conditions) that prevent dissatisfaction.
2. Motivator Factors: Growth needs (recognition, achievement, responsibility) that promote satisfaction and motivation.

5. b)Illustrate the dimensions of Big five Personality type.
The Big Five Personality Traits are:
1. **Openness to Experience:** Curiosity, openness, and love for learning.
2. **Conscientiousness:** Organization, responsibility, and reliability.
3. **Extraversion**: Outgoing, sociable, and assertive.
4. **Agreeableness**: Cooperation, empathy, and kindness.
5. **Neuroticism:** Emotional instability, anxiety, and vulnerability.
These dimensions help understand individual personality differences.
PART-B (3x5=15)
Short Essays
Answer with minimum one page and relevant points justifying the question shall be considered for maximum marks .if partial attempt is made, award 3-4 marks.

6.a)Deduce the key principles of contingency theory. How does it explain the success or failure of leadership in different organisational contexts?
(Give a minimum of 3 marks for the theory explanation)
Key Principles:
1**. No one-size-fits-all approach**: Leadership effectiveness depends on the situation.
2. **Contextual factors**: Leadership success is influenced by factors like task structure, leader-member relations, and the leader's power.
3. **Matching leadership style to situation**: Effective leaders adapt their style to fit the situation.
Explaining Leadership Success or Failure:
1**. Task-oriented leaders**: Effective in structured tasks, but may struggle with ambiguous tasks.
2. **People-oriented leaders**: Effective in situations requiring teamwork and collaboration.
3. **Adaptability**: Leaders who adapt their style to the situation are more likely to succeed.

6,b)Based on the trait theories of leadership, list and briefly explain five important traits that are considered necessary for leaders.
(**Give 3 marks for points, Mark can be awarded for any other related point)**

Five Important Traits:
1**. Intelligence**: Cognitive ability to process information, analyse situations, and make informed decisions.
2. Confidence: Self-assurance and faith in one's abilities, inspiring trust and confidence in others.
3. Integrity: Strong moral principles, ethics, and values, fostering a positive and respectful work environment.
4. Determination: Persistence, resilience, and drive to achieve goals, motivating others to work towards a common objective.
5. Emotional Intelligence: Self-awareness, empathy, and social skills, enabling effective communication, conflict resolution, and team management.

These traits are considered essential for effective leadership, enabling leaders to inspire, motivate, and guide their teams towards achieving organizational goals.

7. a)Explain the key characteristics that distinguish E-Teams from other types of teams.

(Give 2 marks for points, , Mark can be awarded for any other related point/concept)

E-Teams: Key Characteristics

Distinguishing Features:

1**. Virtual Collaboration**: E-Teams work remotely, using digital communication tools to collaborate and share information.

2. **Geographic Dispersion**: Team members are located in different parts of the world, often across multiple time zones.

3. **Technology-Driven**: E-Teams rely heavily on technology, such as video conferencing, instant messaging, and collaborative software.

4. **Flexibility and Autonomy:** E-Team members often have more flexibility in their work schedules and environments.

5. **Cultural Diversity**: E-Teams frequently comprise members from diverse cultural backgrounds, requiring adaptability and cross-cultural understanding.

These characteristics enable E-Teams to work efficiently across boundaries, leveraging diverse skills and expertise to achieve organizational objectives.

7. b)Use the real world organisational scenarios to illustrate various reasons behind group formation.

(If any partial attempt is made, give 2 marks, Marks can be awarded for any other related point/concept)

1. Common Goals: A marketing team forms to launch a new product, sharing the goal of increasing sales.

2. Social Needs: Colleagues from different departments form a social group to support each other and build relationships.

3. Task Interdependence: A cross-functional team forms to develop a new software, requiring collaboration between developers, designers, and testers.

4. Proximity: Employees working in the same department or location naturally form a group due to frequent interactions**.**

5. Shared Interests: A group of employees with a common interest in sustainability form a green team to promote eco-friendly practices.

These scenarios illustrate how groups form in organizations to achieve common objectives, satisfy social needs, or address shared interests**.**

8. a)Mention three key aspects of team building through individual development.

(Give 2 marks even if there is no explanation, Mark can be awarded for any other related point/concept)

1. Skill Enhancement: Developing individual skills and competencies to contribute to team success.

2. Personal Growth: Fostering self-awareness, confidence, and emotional intelligence to improve teamwork and collaboration**.**

3. Leadership Development: Identifying and developing leadership potential within team members to empower them to lead and support the team.

By focusing on individual development, teams can build a strong foundation for collective success, improved collaboration, and enhanced performance.

8. b)Demonstrate the application of the five stages of group development in managing a new project team.

(Give 2 mark even if there is no explanation)
Stages:
1. **Forming:** Establish clear goals, roles, and expectations. Introduce team members, define project scope, and set timelines.
2. **Storming:** Manage conflicts, negotiate roles, and build trust. Encourage open communication, address disagreements, and clarify responsibilities.
3. **Norming:** Foster cohesion, establish norms, and promote collaboration. Encourage teamwork, set standards, and recognize contributions.
4. **Performing:** Empower team members, delegate tasks, and monitor progress. Provide support, resources, and feedback to ensure project momentum.
5. **Adjourning:** Evaluate project success, recognize team achievements, and facilitate closure. Conduct a post-project review, document lessons learned, and celebrate team accomplishments.
By understanding and navigating these stages, project managers can effectively guide their teams through the development process, ensuring successful project outcomes.

PART-C LONG ESSAY (2x20=40)
Answer with key points, relevant examples and explanation shall be considered for 16-19 marks. For partial and fair attempt shall consider for 12-15 marks. Consider an attempt for 7-11 marks.

9. a)Evaluate the real life scenario of self-leadership and explain how self-awareness, proactivity and resilience help an individual in overcoming challenges and achieve goals.
(Given below is an example scenario. Mark can be awarded for any other related point/concept)

Real-Life Scenario:
Consider an entrepreneur, X who launches a sustainable fashion brand. She faces challenges like limited resources, intense competition, and self-doubt.
Key Factors:
1. Self-Awareness: X recognizes her strengths (creativity, passion) and weaknesses (financial management). She delegates tasks and seeks mentorship to fill gaps.
2. Proactivity: X anticipates market trends, adapts her business strategy, and takes calculated risks to stay ahead.
3. Resilience: When faced with setbacks (e.g., failed product lines), Sarah learns from failures, adjusts her approach, and maintains motivation.
Benefits:
1. Improved Decision-Making: Self-awareness helps Sarah make informed decisions.
2. Increased Adaptability: Proactivity enables her to respond to changing circumstances.
3. Enhanced Motivation: Resilience keeps her focused on long-term goals.
By cultivating self-awareness, proactivity, and resilience, individuals like X can effectively overcome challenges, achieve goals, and lead themselves to success.
(Mark can be awarded for any other related point/concept)

9. b)Discuss the role of culture in shaping workplace behaviour and influencing overall organisational conduct.
Culture's Role in Shaping Workplace Behaviour
Impact on Organisational Conduct:
1. **Values and Norms:** Organisational culture defines acceptable behaviour, influencing employee attitudes and actions.
2. **Communication Styles**: Culture affects how employees interact, collaborate, and resolve conflicts.
3. **Decision-Making:** Cultural values shape decision-making processes, prioritising either individualism or collectivism.

4. **Motivation and Engagement:** A positive culture fosters employee motivation, job satisfaction, and commitment.

Organizational Conduct:

1. **Ethics and Integrity:** A strong culture promotes ethical behaviour, accountability, and transparency.
2. **Innovation and Risk-Taking:** A culture embracing experimentation and learning encourages innovation.
3. **Diversity and Inclusion:** An inclusive culture values diverse perspectives, promoting creativity and collaboration.

Conclusion:

Organizational culture plays a significant role in shaping workplace behaviour and influencing overall conduct. A well-defined, positive culture can drive employee engagement, innovation, and success.

(Mark can be awarded for any other related point/concept)

10.a) **Defend the proactive nature of self-leadership using workplace scenarios.**

Proactive Nature of Self-Leadership

Workplace Scenarios:

1. Anticipating Challenges: An employee, anticipating a project's potential roadblocks, proactively develops contingency plans, ensuring timely completion.

2. Seeking Opportunities: A marketing specialist takes initiative to attend industry conferences, networking and staying updated on trends to drive business growth.

3. Self-Development: A software developer identifies skill gaps and proactively pursues online courses, enhancing their expertise and contributing to team success.

Benefits:

1. Increased Productivity: Proactive self-leadership enables employees to manage tasks efficiently.

2. Improved Adaptability: Self-leaders adapt quickly to changing circumstances.

3. Enhanced Job Satisfaction: Taking initiative and achieving goals boosts confidence and job satisfaction.

Conclusion:

Self-leadership's proactive nature empowers individuals to take charge, anticipate challenges, and seize opportunities, driving personal and organizational success.

(Mark can be awarded for any other related point/concept related to self-leadership/ workplace scenarios)

10.b)Examine the role of communication in cross cultural management.

Effective communication is crucial in cross-cultural management as it enables understanding, collaboration, and trust among individuals from diverse backgrounds. It helps to navigate cultural differences, avoid misunderstandings, and build stronger relationships, which are essential for success in globalized business environments.

Here's a more detailed look at the role of communication:

1. Building Trust and Understanding: Cross-cultural communication fosters trust by demonstrating respect for different perspectives and acknowledging cultural variations.

2. Facilitating Collaboration and Teamwork: Effective communication enables teams to leverage diversity as a strength, promoting creativity and innovative problem-solving.

3. Navigating Cultural Differences: Cross-cultural communication helps individuals understand and respect the values, beliefs, and customs of different cultures.

4. Resolving Conflicts and Managing Diversity: Effective communication skills can help navigate potential conflicts arising from cultural differences, promoting constructive dialogue and resolution.

5. Driving Business Success: In today's globalized business environment, cross-cultural communication is essential for establishing relationships, forging partnerships, and negotiating deals with clients and partners from diverse backgrounds

(Mark can be awarded for any other related point/concept related to communication/ cross- cultural management)

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